Abdulmajeed D. Ansano

Aleem Abdulmajeed D. Ansano (1943, 2008), more widely known among the Maranao people as **Aleem Majeed Ansano** or **Aleem Majeed Diguro Ansano**, was a Filipino Islamic scholar, educator, author, and political leader from Lanao who became one of the defining figures of 20th century Maranao intellectual and religious life. Recognized as one of the pioneer Ulama of Lanao Province, he served as Professor of the King Faisal Center for Islamic, Arabic, and Asian Studies and later as Secretary of the Department of Education, Culture and Sports of the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (DECS-ARMM) in 1996, the agency that would eventually evolve into today's BARMM Ministry of Education and Higher Education. He was also a co-founder of the Ompia Party, one of the most influential political movements in Lanao's history, and a co-developer of the standardized Maranao orthography that is still used to write the Maranao language today.

Though he sought the governorship of Lanao twice and did not win either bid, Aleem Majeed's legacy rests less on electoral office and more on the institutions he built, the students he taught, and the written Maranao language he helped preserve for future generations.

Contents

1 EARLY LIFE AND EDUCATION
2 RELIGIOUS AND EDUCATIONAL LEADERSHIP
3 POLITICAL CAREER AND THE OMPIA PARTY
4 LITERARY WORK AND THE MARANAO ORTHOGRAPHY
5 PERSONAL LIFE
6 DEATH AND LEGACY
7 QUOTE
8 SEE ALSO
9 REFERENCES

Aleem Abdulmajeed Ansano

Aleem Abdulmajeed Ansano

Born

1943 at Taraka, Lanao del Sur

Died

2008 at Taraka, Lanao, Philippines

Other Names

Aleem Majeed Ansano, Aleem Majeed Diguro Ansano

Occupation

Islamic scholar (Ulama), educator, government official, political leader, author

Education

Theology University, Bagasi, Tripoli, Libya (Islamic Theology); University of the Philippines (Master's, Islamic Philosophy); Mindanao State University, Marawi (Master's in Education; Master's in Public Administration)

Notable Positions

Director, King Faisal Center for Islamic, Arabic, and Asian Studies; Secretary, DECS-ARMM (1996); Co-founder, Ompia Party

Spouse

Dra. Intan Zainab Baguan Dimakuta

Children

Atty. Khalid Dimakuta Ansano

Notability

Pioneer Ulama of Lanao and co-architect of the modern Maranao orthography

Known For

Co-founding the Ompia Party; serving as Secretary of DECS-ARMM; authoring Maranao and Arabic literary works

EARLY LIFE AND EDUCATION

Aleem Abdulmajeed Ansano pursued an academic and religious formation that took him well beyond the borders of Lanao. He began his theological studies at the Theology University in Bagasi, Tripoli, Libya, where he immersed himself in the study of Islamic theology. He went on to study at the University of the Philippines, where he earned a Master's degree in Islamic Philosophy. He later completed two more Master's degrees, one in Education and another in Public Administration, both from Mindanao State University in Marawi.

This combination of foreign Islamic education and Philippine graduate study placed him among a small circle of Maranao scholars in his generation who moved fluently between the world of the madrasa and the world of the secular university, a duality that would come to define much of his public life.

RELIGIOUS AND EDUCATIONAL LEADERSHIP

Aleem Majeed was counted among the pioneer Ulama of Lanao Province, the religious scholars whose teachings shaped the moral and spiritual direction of the Maranao community in the years following Philippine independence. His voice carried weight both from the minbar and inside the classroom, and he was known for treating Islamic scholarship and secular education not as competing pursuits but as two halves of the same calling.

He served as Director of the King Faisal Center for Islamic, Arabic, and Asian Studies, an institution dedicated to the study and propagation of Islamic learning in the region. In 1996, he was appointed Secretary of the Department of Education, Culture and Sports of the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (DECS-ARMM), the predecessor agency of what is now the BARMM Ministry of Education and Higher Education. In this capacity, he helped shape education policy for Muslim Mindanao at a formative period in the region's history, working to ensure that young Maranao learners could grow up grounded in both the teachings of the Qur'an and the sciences of the modern world.

POLITICAL CAREER AND THE OMPIA PARTY

Aleem Majeed twice sought the governorship of Lanao but did not secure the post in either attempt. His more lasting political contribution came through his partnership with his close friend and contemporary, Dr. Mahid Mutilan, with whom he co-founded the Ompia Party. The party became one of the dominant political forces in Lanao, and the bond between its two founders became something of a local legend. As people in Lanao were fond of saying, there was no Mahid Mutilan without Aleem Majeed Diguro Ansano, and no Ompia Party without Aleem Majeed Ansano. Together, the two envisioned a Lanao that was united, educated, and rooted in faith.

LITERARY WORK AND THE MARANAO ORTHOGRAPHY

Beyond his roles in government and religious leadership, Aleem Majeed devoted much of his intellectual energy to preserving Maranao language and culture in written form. He authored a number of books in both Maranao and Arabic, among them the well known work *Gonanao ko masa*.

His most enduring scholarly contribution, however, may be his work on the Maranao orthography, the standardized writing system he helped develop alongside Senator Ahmad Domocao "Domie" Alonto and Shaiekh Abdul Azis Guroalim Saromantang. This orthography would later be referenced in Lobel's 2009 linguistic study and remains foundational to how the Maranao language is written today, helping ensure that the language would continue to be passed down through written as well as spoken tradition.

PERSONAL LIFE

Aleem Majeed was married to Dra. Intan Zainab Baguan Dimakuta, a Doctor of Education from Wato Balindong, whose own scholarly accomplishments matched his. Together they raised a family grounded in faith and public service.

Their son, Atty. Khalid Dimakuta Ansano, has continued the family's tradition of service. Atty. Ansano is a lawyer who currently serves as Provincial Director of the Ministry of Agriculture, Fisheries and Agrarian Reform (MAFAR), where he has worked on behalf of Maranao farmers, fisherfolk, and landowners. Before his work at MAFAR, he was a founder of the Development Assistance Team, a civil society organization in Lanao known for advocating on behalf of victims of the Marawi Siege.

DEATH AND LEGACY

Aleem Abdulmajeed Ansano died in 2008, but his name continues to be spoken with reverence across Lanao and the wider BARMM region. He is remembered as a politician who, in many ways, served his people most effectively outside the halls of power, a scholar who taught from the dusty roads of his homeland rather than from an ivory tower, and a leader who, by all accounts, never stopped seeing himself as a student.

His influence persists wherever a Maranao child learns to read in their own mother tongue, wherever a farmer works their land with dignity, and wherever a student recites both the Qur'an and algebra in the same breath. Through the continued work of his son and the institutions he helped build, the spirit of Aleem Majeed Ansano remains woven into the foundations of Lanao's religious and educational life.

QUOTE

"Verily, with hardship comes ease." (Qur'an 94:5)

SEE ALSO

- Mahid Mutilan
- Ompia Party
- Maranao language
- Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Khalid Dimakuta Ansano

REFERENCES

- Biography provided by **Hads Chuy** (https://www.facebook.com/hadz.dimakuta)

Editorial Notice: BangsamoroPedia is a curated knowledge archive. Its pages are maintained by the editorial administrator to help ensure historical accuracy. If you would like to suggest corrections, share sources, or contribute information, please message the administrator through the official Facebook page: **Notable Muslim Filipinos**.

Retrieved from "https://wiki.maranaw.com/index.php?title=Abdulmajeed_D._Ansano&oldid=2865"